QP CODE: 24900263 MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

FIRST SEMESTER MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION NOVEMBER 2024

First Semester

Discipline Specific Core Course - **MG1DSCRS100** - MALAYALAM LITERATURE IN ENGLISH TRANSLATION (2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 2 hours Maximum Marks: 70

Remember (K), Understand (U), Apply (A), Analyse (An), Evaluate (E), Create (C), Interest (I), Appreciation (Ap), and Skill (S)

Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability.

[Learning Domain] [CO No(s)]

Part A

*Multiple Choice Questions. Answer **all** questions. Each question carries **1** mark.*

1. Who has translated the play "Matsyagandhi"? [An] [4]
   c) V.C Harris
2. Why does the translator retain the SL word "jalapishaachu" as it is in the translation? [An] [2]
   c)In order to retain the nuances of the source language and culture
   d) Owing to untranslatability
3. What is Kunjupathumma's view on her upcoming marriage? [An] [3]
   b) She feels indifferent but accepts it as her fate.
4. The elephant in the title serves as a metaphor for the family's lost status. [An] [3]
   What does this metaphor reveal about the family's current socio-economic position?
   d) They are struggling financially but cannot let go of their grand past.
5. According to Catford, translation involves: [U] [1]
   b) Replacement of SL text with TL text.
6. What is the primary goal of translation? [U] [1]
   a) To convey SL meaning in TL
7. According to fisherwoman the stench comes from [An] [4]
   c) from the decaying sea
8. What does Kunjupattumma think about her role in choosing her groom? [An] [3]
   b) She knows that she has no say in this matter
9. Why was Kunjupattumma not sad even after learning that the elephant had killed six people? [An] [3]
   b) All the deceased were non--Muslims
10. How has Devika translated the word amritham? [An] [2]
    b) Divine ambrosia

(10 × 1 = 10)

Part B

*Objective Type Questions. Answer any **10** questions. Each question carries **1** mark.*

11. What term does Kunjupattumma's mother use to refer to non-Muslims? [An][3]
    Kafir
12. Where was Muhammad Nabi born? [An] [3]
    Mecca
13. What is Unnikrishnan wailing for at the beginning of the story? [An] [2]
    Unnikrishnan was worried about the disappearance of the stream in which he had bathed joyfully in the evening.
14. Why did Unnikrishnan wash the rice? [An] [2]

He thinks that there is poison in the rice and he washes it.

15. Why does the fisher woman say "let my hair remain untied, unloosened" in the play 'Matsyagandhi"? [An] [4]

So that Kadalamma will grow into a rage and destroy all the trawler boats and foreign vessels.

16. What does the term "Matsyagandhi' refer to in the context of the play? [An] [4]

The challenges and exploitation faced by an Araya woman.

17. What ancestral animal is mentioned frequently in the story Me Grandad 'Ad An Elephant as part of the family's heritage? [An] [3]

Elephant

18. Define full Translation. [U] [1]

Full translation is when every part of the SL text is replaced by TL text material.

19. What do you understand by the term total translation? [U] [1]

Replacing SL grammar and lexis with equivalent TL grammar and lexis - consequential replacement of SL phonology/graphology with non-equivalent TL phonology/graphology.

20. What made Kunjipattumma change her opinion about the "naughty elephant"? [An] [3]

Elephant had killed six people – called it "naughty" - Changed her opinion - all the people the elephant had killed were kafirs - not killed a single muslim.

21. What happens to SL grammar and lexis in total translation? [U] [1]

Replaced by equivalent TL grammar and lexis.

22. Why does the translator retain the Malayalam word kaavadi in the translation? [An] [2]

Due to cultural untranslatabiity - words thus retained are loaded with meanings related to the Kerala culture.

(10 × 1 = 10)

Part C

*Answer Questions (50 Words) Answer any **5** questions. Each question carries **2** marks*

23. Discuss the central problems of translation theory and translation practice. [U] [1]

Defining the nature and conditions of translation equivalence.
Finding TL translation equivalents for SL textual material.

24. Explain the term 'textual material' in Catford's definition. [U] [1]

Emphasizes the specific segments that undergo translation, acknowledging that some elements may remain untranslated or be replaced with non-equivalent material.

25. Critically comment on the role of sea in the play "Matsyagandhi'. [An] [4]

Protagonist's life is intimately connected to the sea - unfolds through her vivid descriptions - stage is imagined as seashore and the audience is the sea - rhythmic language reflects the ebb and flow of the tides.

26. What are the thoughts of Kunjupattumma about her marriage? [An] [3]

Wonders who will come to marry her - whether he will come on an elephant - wishes to chew betel leaves after her marriage - hopes to go for hajj along with umma and bapa.

27. Describe the significance of the wooden sandal worn by Kunjipattumma's mother? [An] [3]

Symbol of their lost fortune - the toe-grips of the sandals are made from the tusk of uppuppa's elephant - one of the reasons for her pride - wears it often to remind herself of their past glory - treasures it as a token of their past life.

28. What is the significance of retaining the word 'jalapishachu' in the translation. [An][2]

Literal meaning of the word is Water Demon - translator has used it to refer to obsessive compulsive behaviour involving washing hands or feet many times for long durations each day - translator might have retained it due to its culturally loaded meaning and to keep the cultural reference.

29. What was Unnikrishnan's fear when he saw the search party approach him? [An] [2]
How did he respond?

Worried that the search party might take over the rivulets - drain away the moisture and the tenderness - shouted at them and tried to stretch out his arms and embrace the water.

30. Analyse the impact of modernization on the traditional communities in reference to the play "Matsyagandhi". [An] [4]

Conventional wooden boats replaced by plywood boats - the trawler boats with their wide nets endangers sea wealth - harbour alienates the Araya community from the sea - have no place to go.

(5 x 2 = 10)

Part D

*Short Essay Questions (150 Words). Answer any **5** questions. Each question carries **5** marks .*

31. How does full translation differ from total translation? [U] [1]

Related but distinct concepts in Catford's theory. Full translation - extent of the translation process - every part of the Source Language (SL) text is subjected to translation -replaced by Target Language (TL) material - focuses on the breadth of the text being translated. Total translation is a technical term - involves the comprehensive replacement of SL text - specifically entails replacing SL grammar and lexis with equivalent TL grammar and lexis - includes the consequential replacement of SL phonology/graphology with non-equivalent TL phonology/graphology - delves into the specific levels of language being addressed - highlighting that not all linguistic levels achieve equivalence, especially phonological and graphological aspects.

32. Compare and contrast the personalities of Kunjupattumma's parents and their influence on her life. How do their individual views contribute to her restricted choices? [An] [3]

Kunjutachumma, Kunjupattuma's mother - boasts of her being the daughter of Anamakkar who owned a huge elephant - reminds her daughter of their past glory - restricts her from interacting with the world. Vattan Adima, Kunjupattuma's father - a rich and influential person - both are quite conservative - strictly follow the traditional customs and practices - groom their daughter according to the precepts of Islam - not allowed to wear sari, or comb her hair or to stand in front of her house in the moonlight - never send her to school - neglected her dreams because of their superstitious beliefs.

33. Describe the childhood of Kunjupattumma. [An] [3]

Born and brought up in a rich Muslim family - grew up as a conventional muslim girl - pampered and cared in her younger days - black mole on the cheek seen as a sign of luck – no formal education - childhood fantasies neglected because of their superstitious beliefs – obedient - grew up as a caged bird - saw the outside world only when they lost their wealth.

34. Why does Catford make a distinction between the terms, 'text' and 'textual material'? Explain. [U][1]

Distinguishes between 'textual material' and 'text' to highlight that not every part of the Source Language (SL) text is translated into the Target Language (TL). 'textual material' emphasizes the specific segments that undergo translation, acknowledging that some elements may remain untranslated or be replaced with non-equivalent material - distinction allows for a more nuanced understanding of the translation process, where only certain parts of the text are actively replaced, while others are simply transferred or retained in their original form - Catford points out that translation is not a wholesale substitution of one language for another but involves selective replacement based on equivalence and contextual considerations - underscores the complexity of translation - maintaining the integrity and meaning of the original text may require leaving some elements untranslated to preserve local color or due to the absence of direct equivalents in the TL.

35. Explore the symbolism of fish in the play "Matsyagandhi". How does it represent for the protagonist and her community? [An][4]

Araya woman portrays what it means to be a fisherwoman in the age of globalization - "Matsya" meaning fish, connects the protagonist to her livelihood and dependence on the sea. Her fish-stink is her identity - fate of the fishing community and the 'little baby fishes' is the same- slaughtered by the big trawler vessels - Araya community belongs to Kadalamma just like the fishes.

36. Discuss how Bombay acts as a foil to Unnikrishnan's village. Comment on how the two locales shape Unnikrishnan and his perception of reality. [An][2]

Bombay brought out the disorder associated with cleanliness - just 25 when he went to Bombay - saw blood everywhere - dirt outside - afraid of stepping - thought of going back to his home and village to bring about a change in this condition - disorder seems to haunt him even when he is back in his village - washes even the religious books and idol - two locales contributed to the character formation of Unnikrishnan.

37. Attempt a character sketch of Unnikrishnan. [An] [2]

Young man from a village in Kerala - lived with his wife in Bombay - obsessed with the uncleanliness around him - spends hours washing his hands and feet – hopes to be back in his village to be away from the illusions of blood everywhere - but unable to find a solace there - habit of disappearing in the middle of the night - results in his ultimate disappearance – River/rivulet and water plays an important role in the story.

38. How did things change in the Araya community after the commencement of harbour and trawler boats in the play "Matsyagandhi"? [An][4]

Play discusses the harsh realities faced by the Araya community in contemporary Kerala – news of the construction of the new harbour gives them hopes of more employment opportunities - but ultimately takes them away from the sea, their only means of livelihood - modernization and globalisation bring trawler boats and foreign vessels to the sea - depletes the sea wealth - threatens their livelihood - boat accidents become common taking lives of Araya folks - themes of ecological destruction of the sea due to man's greed- double marginalization of Araya women - systematic exploitation of the fishing communities.

(5× 5 = 25)

Part E

*Essay Questions (300 Words). Answer any **1** question. Each question carries **15** marks.*

39 Discuss how Vaikom Muhammad Basheer uses irony and humor to depict the life of Kunjupattumma in Me Grandad 'Ad An Elephant. How do these literary devices contribute to the portrayal of her family's situation and attitudes? [An] [3]

Humorous anecdotes - superstitious beliefs and conventional way of living - Kunjupattuma grew up in a rich background - following all the muslim religious customs and practices - life became difficult when the family lost their properties in family litigation -her mother, Kunjutachumma, always boasts about the elephant that her father had - hides their present shortcomings. End of the novel - children shouting 'elephant ant'. Illiterate Kunjupattumma - her dreams and fears- the conflict between the values Kunjupattumma upholds and those of the educated, forward-looking Nisar Ahmad's family.

40 "Critically evaluate J.Devika's translation of ""Nilavu Ariyunnu"", focusing on the translation strategies, techniques and theoretical concepts employed. How far has the translation succeeded in capturing the nuances of the source language and culture? " [An] [2]

Devika's translation captures the nuances, moods, and tone of the original story's complex narrative and symbolic language. "The Moonlight Knows" - about a woman who is unable to save her husband who has become insane due to the realities of urban life - story explores the relationship between humans and nature - how nature can represent society's exploitative structures of power. Obsessive Compulsive Disorder of the protagonist presented by connecting it to the cultural milieux – task of finding equivalents for dialectical variations and its expressions in the target language met to a certain extent - translator retains a lot of Malayalam words - examples include terms like *Valyammavan, Cheru, jalapishachu, kaavadi.* - atmosphere of the joint family and village life recreated - Uses the beliefs and superstitions of the family - Hindu mantra connected to body washing is retained - translation of Amritham to Divine Ambrosia - translator uses both the words - role of river/rivulet in the protagonist's life is explained in detail in the translation too.

(1 × 15 = 15)

END OF THE QUESTION PAPER